

EUANGELION · A SERIES

Saved & Faithing

A seven-day walk through salvation, the words of Jesus, and the three baptisms.

“What does it actually mean to be saved?”

σώζω · πιστεύω · βαπτίζω · συνθάπτω

רוח · אמונה · ישע

THE WALK

Day 1 Saved From What? — **Luke 19:10**

Day 2 His Own Words — **John 14:6**

Day 3 Saved, Being Saved, Will Be Saved — **Ephesians 2:8-9**

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Day 5 Baptism of Water — **Acts 2:38**

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Saved From What?

Anchor: Luke 19:10

“For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost.”

— Luke 19:10 (NIV)

ἦλθεν γὰρ ὁ υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου ζητῆσαι καὶ σῶσαι τὸ ἀπολωλός.

Read also: “Jesus said to him, 'Today salvation has come to this house, because this man, too, is a son of Abraham. For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost.'” — Luke 19:9-10

THE WORD BEFORE THE WORD

Salvation is not a label you wear. It is a rescue you receive — and you must be willing to name what you are being rescued from.

Before salvation can mean anything, we have to answer the smaller, sharper question underneath it: saved from what? Most of us were handed the word salvation already polished — a transaction completed somewhere in our past, filed in a folder labeled 'taken care of.' But Jesus does not speak of salvation that way. He stands in front of a tax collector named Zacchaeus and says it: He came to seek and to save the lost. He names the condition first.

Lost is a posture, not a verdict. It means standing in a place we cannot get out of by ourselves. Lost in habits we did not choose and cannot finish. Lost in stories about ourselves that no longer hold weight. Lost in the cluttered, hungry life. Salvation begins where we stop pretending we are fine.

WORD STUDY

σώζω

sōzō

Greek · Strong's G4982 · pronunciation: SOHD-zoh

Definition. to save, rescue, deliver, heal, make whole

Root. σώζω is a wide word. The Gospels use it for healing the sick, calming a storm, raising a dead girl, and forgiving sin — all the same verb. To be saved is to be pulled out of what is killing us and set on our feet again. The noun form, σωτηρία (sōtēria), describes the whole rescue: deliverance from peril, restoration to wholeness, and ongoing safekeeping.

Usage. When the New Testament reaches for the word save, it does not flatten it to a single afterlife event. It uses one verb to cover the whole rescue: physical, relational, moral, and eternal. Jesus heals a bleeding woman with the same word Paul uses for our deliverance from sin and death.

יָשָׁא (yāsha') — Hebrew root meaning 'to deliver, rescue, bring to safety.' This root is the source of the name Yeshua (Jesus). His name is the saving act — the rescue announced in a person. Strong's H3467.

σωτηρία (sōtēria) — The noun: salvation, deliverance, preservation. Strong's G4991. The full state of being rescued and kept.

σωτήρ (sōtēr) — Savior — the one who does the rescuing. Strong's G4990. Used for Jesus throughout the New Testament.

HIS NAME IS THE RESCUE

When Matthew records the angel's instruction to Joseph, the sentence is almost a definition: you shall call his name Yeshua, for he will save his people from their sins. The name itself, Yeshua, comes from the Hebrew root *yāsha'* — to deliver, to bring out into a wide place. The name is the saving act. To say Jesus is to say rescue.

Luke 19:10 specifies the scope. He came to seek and to save the lost. Three verbs, one mission. Seek is the active hunt — He moves toward the one who cannot move toward Him. Save is the deliverance He performs once He arrives. Lost is who we were before we knew His name. The incarnation is rescue with a face. He does not stand at a distance and shout instructions; He walks into the ruin and lifts us out. That is what we are remembering when we say the word salvation. Not a contract. A coming.

Historical context. The Hebrew name Yehoshua (later shortened to Yeshua) was not invented for the Messiah. It was a common Israelite name meaning 'Yahweh saves.' Joshua, who led Israel into the promised land, carried the same name. The angel's command to Joseph in Matthew 1:21 is therefore both familiar and devastating — this child will be what every Yeshua before Him pointed toward.

Note. The Greek word ἀπολῶλος in Luke 19:10, translated 'lost,' is the perfect participle of ἀπόλλυμι — literally, 'the one having been destroyed.' Jesus does not see the lost as merely misplaced. He sees them as already perishing, and He came to reach them anyway. N.T. Wright argues across his work — including *Surprised by Hope* (HarperOne, 2008) — that salvation in the New Testament is not God evacuating us from a doomed world but God's rescue project for the whole creation, inaugurated in the resurrection and brought to completion when heaven and earth are made one. Rescue from, but also rescue for.

BRIDGE

Ancient truth. Jesus stood in front of Zacchaeus, a wealthy collaborator everyone had written off, and announced that salvation had come to his house — because the Son of Man came to seek and save the lost.

Modern application. We carry the same condition under different names: the cluttered calendar, the appetite that never settles, the version of ourselves we keep performing because the real one is too tired. We need rescue, not a polish.

Connection. Daily bread for the cluttered, hungry soul begins here — admitting we are hungry, admitting we are cluttered, admitting we cannot save ourselves. Naming what we are being rescued from is the first honest sentence of the walk.

New Testament echo. John 3:16-17 tightens the lens: God sent the Son not to condemn the world but to save it. The same verb — σώζω. The same direction — toward us, not away from us. And Isaiah 43:1 holds the prelude: 'I have redeemed you; I have summoned you by name; you are mine.'

PRAYER

Jesus, Yeshua, your name is the rescue. I have called myself many things, but today I will say the truer one: I am one of the lost you came to seek. I cannot pull myself out of the cluttered, hungry life, and I am tired of pretending I can. Come find me here. Save me from sin's grip, from the futility I keep mistaking for a life, from the death that waits underneath every shortcut. Save me into you. Amen.

Breathe in: 'I am sought.' Breathe out: 'I am saved.'

REFLECTION

If salvation is rescue, what specifically are you needing to be rescued from right now — not in theory, but in the particulars of this week?

- **Where have you been treating salvation like a finished transaction instead of an ongoing rescue you still need today?**
- **What would it cost you to say out loud, 'I am one of the lost He came to seek' — and what might it free?**

TAKEAWAY

Today I will name one thing I need rescuing from. Not an abstraction — a specific habit, fear, story, or appetite. I will say it to Jesus by name and ask Him, by His name, to save me out of it.

LEAVING AT THE CROSS

- The polished version of salvation that never required me to name what I was being saved from
- The quiet pride that keeps me performing wholeness while my interior is starving
- The lie that I am too far in, too late, or too complicated for Jesus to come find

RECEIVING FROM THE CROSS

- The mercy of being sought — Jesus is the one moving toward me, not the other way around
- A wider word for salvation: rescue from sin, from futility, from death, and into Christ Himself
- Permission to be honest about my condition without losing my belovedness

His Own Words

Anchor: John 14:6

“Jesus answered, 'I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.'”

— John 14:6 (NIV)

ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ὁδὸς καὶ ἡ ἀλήθεια καὶ ἡ ζωὴ· οὐδεὶς ἔρχεται πρὸς τὸν πατέρα εἰ μὴ δι’ ἐμοῦ.

Read also: “John 5:24 (NIV) — 'Very truly I tell you, whoever hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life and will not be judged but has crossed over from death to life.' John 6:47 (NIV) — 'Very truly I tell you, the one who believes has eternal life.' In the Greek, both verses open with ἀμὴν ἀμὴν — amēn, amēn — and the verb for believes is πιστεύων, a present active participle: the one who keeps on trusting.” — John 5:24; John 6:47

WHEN THE SALVATION CONVERSATION GETS LOUD

Jesus defined salvation before any theologian did. The red letters are the first draft, not the footnote.

The conversation about salvation has gotten loud. Preachers swear by their formula. Books promise a sharper version. Threads and reels argue the fine print — what really counts, what does not, who is in, who has missed it. By the time the noise reaches us, salvation can feel less like rescue and more like a test we are about to fail.

There is a relief older than every commentary on the shelf: open the Gospels and read the words in red. Jesus answered the question Himself, in His own voice, before any later doctrinal layer. To Nicodemus at night. To a Samaritan woman at noon. To a thief on a cross. To Thomas in a locked room. He said it plainly, and He said it often. When the salvation conversation in your head gets noisy, listen to His voice first.

WORD STUDY

ΠΙΣΤΕΥΩ

pisteuō

Greek · Strong's G4100 · pronunciation: pis-TYOO-oh

Definition. to trust, to believe, to entrust oneself, to keep on trusting

Root. πιστεύω is built on the noun πίστις (pistis) — trust, fidelity, conviction. The verb is the noun set in motion. To pisteuō is not to mentally agree with a fact; it is to lean the weight of your life onto something. John uses the construction πιστεύειν εἰς — 'to trust into' — to make the direction unmistakable: faith is not held about Jesus; it is leaned into Him.

Usage. In Jesus' great salvation sayings — John 3:16, 5:24, 6:47, 11:25-26 — the verb appears as a present active indicative or present active participle: ὁ πιστεύων, 'the one who is trusting.' Greek present-active forms describe continuous, ongoing action. Jesus is not naming a moment; He is naming a posture. The one who keeps on trusting has eternal life — has, present tense, already crossed over. The decision is real. The trust does not stop at the decision.

ἀμήν (amēn) — **amēn** — Hebrew loanword from the root aman (to be firm, faithful). 'Truly, firm, sure.' In John, Jesus doubles it — amēn, amēn — to mark His weightiest sayings about salvation. The double amēn is a translator's signal: He is about to define something.

πίστις (pistis) — The noun: trust, fidelity, conviction. The thing that pisteuō does. Pistis is what you carry; pisteuō is how you carry it.

אמן (aman) — **aman** — The Hebrew root behind both amēn and emunah. To confirm, support, lean on, be firm. The same root Habakkuk uses for the faithfulness by which the righteous live.

THE &APOS;I AM&APOS; SAYINGS AS SELF-PORTRAIT

Jesus did not give us a doctrine of salvation; He gave us Himself, and called that the salvation.

John records seven sayings in which Jesus reaches back to the divine name given to Moses — ἐγώ εἰμι, 'I AM' — and finishes the sentence about Himself. I am the bread of life. I am the light of the world. I am the door. I am the good shepherd. I am the resurrection and the life. I am the way, the truth, and the life. I am the true vine. Each saying answers a particular hunger, and each one defines salvation by handing us a person rather than a procedure.

The red letters cluster here. Salvation, in Jesus' own words, is not chiefly a status to be claimed but a Christ to be entered — a door walked through, a vine remained in, a shepherd followed, a way lived. When our salvation language gets noisy, the 'I am' sayings are the tuning fork. They take the conversation back to the One who is its content.

Historical context. The seven 'I am' (ἐγώ εἰμι) sayings in John echo the divine self-identification of Exodus 3:14, where God answers Moses from the burning bush: 'I AM WHO I AM.' First-century Jewish hearers would have caught the resonance immediately, which is why John 8:58 — 'before Abraham was born, I am' — provoked an attempt to stone Him. The same construction is repurposed in the seven self-portraits: bread, light, door, shepherd, resurrection, way, vine.

Note. John's Gospel uses the verb πιστεύω (to trust) ninety-eight times — more than any other New Testament book — and never once uses the noun πίστις (faith). For John, faith is something you do, not something you have.

BRIDGE

Ancient truth. Jesus answered the question of salvation in His own voice — first to a Pharisee at night, then to a crowd looking for bread, then to a friend at a tomb, then to His followers on the night before His death. The red letters cluster around a single posture: the one who keeps on trusting has eternal life, already, present tense.

Modern application. Our era has more salvation content than any generation before us, and more confusion about it. The fix is not louder takes; it is quieter listening. Open John. Read what Jesus actually said. Let His voice be the first one in the room.

Connection. Day 1 named what we are being rescued from. Day 2 brings us to the One doing the rescuing — and lets Him define His own work. Before we layer in tradition, denomination, or argument, we sit at His feet and hear how He talks about it.

New Testament echo. John 14:6 sits inside a longer conversation. A few verses earlier Jesus says, 'Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God; believe also in me' (John 14:1, NIV). The verb is πιστεύετε — present active. Keep on trusting. The exclusivity of John 14:6 is not a gate slammed shut; it is a door named Jesus, and the door stands open to anyone who will keep walking through Him.

PRAYER

Jesus, the conversation about You has gotten loud, and I have let other voices speak first. Today I want Yours. You said You are the way, the truth, and the life. You said the one who hears Your word and trusts the Father who sent You has already crossed from death to life. I take You at Your word. Quiet the noise that crowds out Your voice. Teach me to keep on trusting — not once, but in this hour, and the next, and the one after that. Amen.

Breathe in: 'I trust His voice.' Breathe out: 'I quiet the others.'

REFLECTION

Whose voice has been loudest in your understanding of salvation lately — and what would change if you let Jesus speak first, in His own words, before anyone else weighed in?

- Which of the 'I am' sayings answers a hunger you are carrying right now — bread, light, door, shepherd, resurrection, way, or vine?
- If pisteuō is present-tense and continuous, what does keeping on trusting Him look like in the next hour of your day?

TAKEAWAY

I will read one chapter of John today, slowly, paying attention to the words in red — letting Jesus' own voice define salvation before any other voice does.

LEAVING AT THE CROSS

- The version of salvation I assembled from someone else's argument before I had heard Jesus' own words
- The pressure to settle every doctrinal question before I am allowed to keep on trusting Him
- The noisy salvation conversation that drowns out the quieter, surer voice of the One it is supposedly about

RECEIVING FROM THE CROSS

- The red letters as the first draft of salvation — Jesus defining His own work in His own voice
- Pisteuō as a present-tense verb — continuous trust, conjugated through every hour of an ordinary day
- An 'I am' for whatever hunger I am actually carrying — bread, light, door, shepherd, resurrection, way, or vine

Saved, Being Saved, Will Be Saved

Anchor: Ephesians 2:8-9

“For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith — and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God — not by works, so that no one can boast.”

— Ephesians 2:8-9 (NIV)

τῇ γὰρ χάριτί ἐστε σεσωσμένοι διὰ πίστεως· καὶ τοῦτο οὐκ ἐξ ὑμῶν, θεοῦ τὸ δῶρον·
οὐκ ἐξ ἔργων, ἵνα μὴ τις καυχῆσται.

Read also: “Therefore, my dear friends, as you have always obeyed — not only in my presence, but now much more in my absence — continue to work out your salvation with fear and trembling, for it is God who works in you to will and to act in order to fulfill his good purpose.” — Philippians 2:12-13 (NIV)

WHEN YOUR STORY WILL NOT TIDY UP

Salvation has three tenses, not one. The accountant in your head is auditing the wrong ledger.

There is a particular kind of doubt that visits people who have been around the gospel for years. It does not come as outright unbelief. It comes as a small accountant in the back of the head, totaling whether your story is tidy enough to count. Other people, you imagine, have a clean conversion testimony — a date, a moment, a before and after. Yours is messier. You wonder if you really did it right. You wonder if you are saved.

Paul does not write to people with tidy testimonies. He writes to a church in Ephesus and uses three different tenses for the same word in the same letter. You have been saved. You are being saved. You will be saved. Not three contradictions. Three angles on one rescue.

Salvation is not a moment you have to remember clearly enough. It is a story God is telling, in three tenses, with you inside it.

WORD STUDY

σώζω

sōzō

Greek · Strong's G4982 · pronunciation: SODZ-oh

Definition. to save, rescue, deliver, make whole

Root. Day 1 introduced σώζω as the wide rescue word. Today we slow down and watch what it does in three tenses. Greek conjugates verbs more precisely than English, and Paul exploits that precision. The same root verb appears across the New Testament in past, present, and future forms, and each form carries a distinct claim about what God has done, is doing, and will do.

Usage. Three tense forms carry the weight of the saved life. PAST — σεσωσμένοι (sesōsmenoi), perfect passive participle, 'having been saved' — appears in Ephesians 2:8: 'by grace you have been saved.' The Greek perfect names a completed action with standing, present effect; the rescue happened, and it still holds. PRESENT — σωζομένοις / σωζομένους (sōzomenois / sōzomenous), present passive participle, 'those being saved' — appears in 1 Corinthians 1:18 ('to us who are being saved it is the power of God') and Acts 2:47 ('the Lord added to their number daily those who were being saved'). The Greek present is durative; the verb is still moving. FUTURE — σωθήσόμεθα / σωθήσεσθε (sōthēsometha / sōthēsesthe), future passive indicative, 'we shall be saved' — appears in Romans 5:9 ('how much more shall we be saved from God's wrath through him') and 1 Peter 1:9 ('the salvation of your souls'). The future tense names what is not yet finished but is already promised.

σωτηρία (sōteria) — G4991 — the noun, salvation. 1 Peter 1:9 names it 'the salvation of your souls' as the goal of faith — the destination the three tenses are walking toward.

κατεργάζεσθε (katergazesthe) — Philippians 2:12 — 'work out.' Present middle imperative. Paul does not say work for your salvation; he says work it out — bring to its full effect what God has already begun in you (v. 13).

TWO FAITHFUL READINGS, ONE GREEK

Two great traditions have walked this terrain and emphasized different points on the arc, and both are reading the same Greek tenses honestly.

The Reformed tradition leans into the perfect tense of Ephesians 2:8 — *sesōsmenoi*, you have been saved — and hears the doctrine of perseverance. If salvation is God's completed gift, then the One who began the good work will carry it to completion (Philippians 1:6). Assurance rests on what God has done, not on the steadiness of our grip. The Synod of Dort (1618-1619) named this the perseverance of the saints.

The Wesleyan tradition leans into the present tense of 1 Corinthians 1:18 and the imperative of Philippians 2:12 — those being saved, work out your salvation — and hears progressive sanctification. Salvation is something God is actively doing; we cooperate with grace as the Spirit conforms us to Christ. John Wesley pressed this present tense toward what he called entire sanctification, the heart fully responsive to God's love.

The Greek holds both. The perfect happened. The present is happening. The future is coming.

Historical context. The Synod of Dort (1618-1619) responded to the Remonstrants by articulating perseverance of the saints — the conviction that those whom God has effectively called He keeps to the end. A century later, John Wesley's sermons on Christian perfection (notably 'Christian Perfection,' 1741, and 'A Plain Account of Christian Perfection,' 1766) pressed the present tense of salvation toward a heart wholly given to love of God and neighbor. Both readings are Scripture's own emphases; the Greek tenses underwrite both. Robert Wilken traces this kind of charitable cohabitation across the early church in *The Spirit of Early Christian Thought* (Yale University Press, 2003).

BRIDGE

Ancient truth. Paul writes to the Ephesians in the perfect tense — *sesōsmenoi*, having been saved — and to the Philippians in the present imperative: work out your salvation, for God is working in you. Both sentences belong to the same gospel.

Modern application. We want closure. We want a date stamped on the rescue and a clean ledger underneath it. Paul refuses to give us one tense when the gospel has three. The perfect tells us the rescue has already happened. The present tells us the Spirit is still at work. The future tells us none of this depends on our ability to wrap it up neatly today.

Connection. Assurance and effort are not opposites. They are the same posture in different tenses. To be saved is to rest in what God has finished, to lean into what He is doing, and to hope toward what He has promised — all at once.

New Testament echo. Romans 5:9 (NIV): 'Since we have now been justified by his blood, how much more shall we be saved from God's wrath through him!' Past justification, future salvation, in one sentence. 1 Peter 1:9 (NIV) names the destination: 'the end result of your faith, the salvation of your souls.'

PRAYER

Father, I have been auditing the wrong ledger. I have been demanding closure on a story You are still telling. Today I receive what You have already done in Christ — the rescue secured before I knew to ask. I lean into what Your Spirit is doing now — the slow, faithful, ongoing work of conforming me to Jesus. And I hope toward what You have promised — the salvation of my soul, brought home on the day He returns. Teach me to live in three tenses without panic. Amen.

Breathe in: 'I have been saved.' Breathe out: 'I am being saved.'

REFLECTION

Which of the three tenses do you find hardest to trust right now — the perfect (it has already been done), the present (it is being done), or the future (it will be brought home)? Name the one that is hardest, and ask why.

- **Where have you been treating salvation as a single tidy moment, and what would change if you let it be a story in three tenses?**
- **Whose voice — Reformed assurance or Wesleyan progress — does your heart most need to hear today, and how might both speak to you in turn?**

TAKEAWAY

I will stop demanding closure on what God is still working out. Today I will rest in the perfect tense, lean into the present, and hope toward the future — and I will let one specific area of my life be unfinished without panicking.

LEAVING AT THE CROSS

- The accountant in my head who keeps demanding a tidier conversion story than the one God is actually telling
- The pressure to flatten salvation into a single past moment I can prove I had
- The anxious habit of measuring my standing by today's mood instead of by what Christ has finished

RECEIVING FROM THE CROSS

- The perfect tense — *sesōsmenoi* — a rescue that already happened and still holds, secured in Christ before I knew to ask
- The present tense — *sōzomenois* — the Spirit's ongoing work in me today, slower than I want and surer than I feel
- The future tense — *sōthēsometha* — the promise that what God began and is doing will be brought home when Jesus returns

RELATED SCRIPTURE

1 Corinthians 1:18. “For the message of the cross is foolishness to those who are perishing, but to us who are being saved it is the power of God.”

Romans 5:9. “Since we have now been justified by his blood, how much more shall we be saved from God's wrath through him!”

1 Peter 1:9. “For you are receiving the end result of your faith, the salvation of your souls.”

Philippians 1:6. “Being confident of this, that he who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus.”

Faithing

Anchor: Habakkuk 2:4

“See, the enemy is puffed up; his desires are not upright — but the righteous person will live by his faithfulness.”

— Habakkuk 2:4 (NIV)

הַיְהוָה עָפָלָה לֹא־יִשְׁרָה נַפְשׁוֹ בּוֹ וְצַדִּיק בְּאֱמוּנָתוֹ יִחְיֶה

FAITH WAS ALWAYS MEANT TO MOVE

The noun faith sits on a shelf. The verb faithing steps off the cliff.

Three days in, we have traced what salvation rescues us from, what Jesus said about it, and how it unfolds across past, present, and future. Today the camera turns. The question is no longer what God has done but how we live inside it.

Habakkuk left us a small, load-bearing word: *emunah*. The righteous, he said, will live by their *emunah* — their faithfulness. Paul picked the line up and ran it into the heart of the gospel. The righteous live by *pistis*. Not by certainty. Not by feeling. Not by the strength of a one-time decision. By a verb that keeps moving.

We call this faithing — not because we invented something new, but because English smoothed faith into a noun on a shelf. Greek and Hebrew never did. They kept it stepping.

WORD STUDY

πίστις / πιστεύω

pistis / pisteuō

Greek · Strong's G4102 · pronunciation: PIS-tis / pis-TYOO-oh

Definition. trust, fidelity, conviction (noun) / to trust, to entrust oneself, to keep on trusting (verb)

Root. Greek preserved faith as both noun and verb. Pistis is what you carry; pisteuō is what you do with it. The verb is present active — durative, ongoing — a continuous entrusting rather than a single act of belief. When Paul cites Habakkuk in Romans 1:17 he writes ho dikaios ek pisteōs zēsetai: the righteous one keeps living out of faith.

Usage. Pistis appears 243 times in the New Testament; pisteuō, 241. The verb dominates John's Gospel, where Jesus invites people not to have faith but to keep on trusting (pisteuein eis — to entrust oneself into him). Faith is conjugated, not collected.

אמונה — **emunah** — Habakkuk 2:4 — 'faithfulness, steadfastness.' Built from the root aman (the same root behind amen). Emunah describes Moses' hands held up at Rephidim (Exodus 17:12) — steady, sustained, hour after hour.

אמן — **aman** — The verbal root: to confirm, support, be firm. To say amen is to faith out loud — to lend your weight to what was said.

FAITH WITH FEET ON

James saw a faith that had stopped moving and called it dead: "Faith by itself, if it is not accompanied by action, is dead" (James 2:17, NIV). He was not subtracting from Paul; he was finishing the sentence. Paul says we are justified by pistis apart from works of the law. James says the pistis that justifies is never apart from itself — it walks. Abraham's faith was credited as righteousness (Genesis 15:6) and then walked Isaac up Moriah. Same pistis. Both verses. Both true.

Hebrews 11 reads like a roll call of verbs: by faith Abel offered, Noah built, Abraham went, Moses refused. The chapter never says these people had faith. It says they faithed. Dietrich Bonhoeffer named the alternative cheap grace — grace severed from the discipleship that proves it real. Costly grace, he wrote, costs us our lives because it gives us our lives. That is faithing. Faith with its shoes on.

Historical context. James 2 was likely written to Jewish believers steeped in emunah, where faith already implied embodied loyalty.

BRIDGE

Ancient truth. The righteous live by emunah — sustained covenantal faithfulness, steady as Moses' lifted hands at Rephidim.

Modern application. English flattened faith into a noun you can own and forget. Pistis and emunah are conjugated — something you do today and again tomorrow.

Connection. Past, present, and future salvation are held by one thread: a verb. We were saved by faithing, are being saved by faithing, will be saved by faithing.

New Testament echo. Romans 1:17 quotes Habakkuk 2:4 word for word. Paul read emunah and wrote pistis; the meaning never bent.

PRAYER

Father, I have treated faith like a possession — something I owned once and could set down. Today I want to faith instead. Show me the next small step, the one that scares me, and let me take it. When the ground feels thin, remind me that emunah was never about my certainty but about Your faithfulness. Amen.

Breathe in: 'I trust.' Breathe out: 'I trust again.'

REFLECTION

Where in your life is faith currently a noun you own — and where could it become a verb you practice today?

- **What have you been waiting to feel certain about before you would act on it?**
- **If pistis is a present-tense verb, what does faithing the next ten minutes look like?**

TAKEAWAY

Today I will faith the one specific thing that scares me — one small step taken before the certainty arrives, trusting that the verb itself is how the righteous live.

LEAVING AT THE CROSS

- The version of faith that lives on a shelf — owned, archived, rarely used.
- The lie that I must feel certain before I am allowed to obey.
- The cheap grace that asks nothing of me because it has forgotten what it cost.

RECEIVING FROM THE CROSS

- Emunah as a posture: steady hands held up, sustained by God's faithfulness more than mine.
- Pistis as a verb: present-tense, repeatable, available every breath.
- Permission to take the next small step before the fear has finished speaking.

RELATED SCRIPTURE

Romans 1:17. “For in the gospel the righteousness of God is revealed — a righteousness that is by faith from first to last, just as it is written: ‘The righteous will live by faith.’”

Hebrews 11:1. “Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see.”

James 2:17. “In the same way, faith by itself, if it is not accompanied by action, is dead.”

Baptism of Water

Anchor: Acts 2:38

“Peter replied, 'Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.'”

— Acts 2:38 (NIV)

Πέτρος δὲ πρὸς αὐτούς· Μετανοήσατε, καὶ βαπτισθήτω ἕκαστος ὑμῶν ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ εἰς ἄφεσιν τῶν ἁμαρτιῶν ὑμῶν, καὶ λήμψεσθε τὴν δωρεὰν τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος.

Read also: “At that time Jesus came from Nazareth in Galilee and was baptized by John in the Jordan. Just as Jesus was coming up out of the water, he saw heaven being torn open and the Spirit descending on him like a dove. And a voice came from heaven: 'You are my Son, whom I love; with you I am well pleased.' (Mark 1:9-11, NIV)” — Mark 1:9-11

JESUS WALKED IN FIRST

Water baptism is not a private emotion made damp. It is the visible sign of an invisible reality — and Jesus walked into it before He asked anyone else to.

Before Peter ever stood up at Pentecost and said the word baptize, Jesus walked down the bank of the Jordan and into the water Himself. The river was cold. The crowd was watching. John was already in up to his waist, soaked to the chest, calling Israel to repent. And Jesus, who needed no repenting, took off his outer cloak and waded out to him.

This is where the saved life starts to wear a body. The first four days of this week have been mostly interior work — naming what we are saved from, seeing the rescue with a face, holding past-present-future together, learning faith as a verb. Today the verb steps into water.

Mark records what happened next in three quick beats. Jesus came up. The heavens tore open. The Spirit descended like a dove. The Father spoke. The visible sign and the invisible reality happened in the same breath — and Jesus did it first.

WORD STUDY

βαπτίζω

baptizō

Greek · Strong's G907 · pronunciation: bap-TID-zoh

Definition. to immerse, submerge, plunge under; figuratively, to overwhelm or fully saturate

Root. βαπτίζω is the intensive form of βάπτω (baptō, 'to dip'). The word denotes not a sprinkle but a plunging under — full saturation, going beneath the surface and coming back up changed by what one has gone into. It is the verb of cloth dyed by being submerged, of a ship overwhelmed by the sea.

Usage. The lexical core of βαπτίζω is immersion — total saturation, not surface contact. This is widely agreed across Greek lexicons (BDAG, LSJ, Thayer's). What the word does NOT settle is the question of mode in Christian practice: faithful traditions today baptize by immersion, by pouring, and by sprinkling, each citing scripture and history. The lexical observation is honest; the tradition question is downstream of it.

מִקְוֶה (*miqweh*) — **miqweh** — A collection or gathering of water — specifically, the Levitical ritual immersion pool used in Second Temple Judaism for purification before entering sacred space. Archaeologists have uncovered hundreds of miqva'ot around Jerusalem and at Qumran. This is the soil baptizō grew in: when John called Israel to the Jordan, he was inviting them into a familiar Jewish practice of ritual immersion, repurposed for the new thing God was about to do.

βάπτω (*baptō*) — The simpler verb: to dip. Used for dipping a finger in water (Luke 16:24), a piece of bread in a dish (John 13:26). βαπτίζω is its intensive cousin — not a brief dip, but a full going-under.

βάπτισμα (*baptisma*) — The noun: the act and result of baptism. Used both for the rite itself and, in Jesus' own mouth, for the death He was about to undergo (Mark 10:38) — a baptism wider than water.

TWO FAITHFUL READINGS

Faithful Christians have read these texts and arrived at two different — and both ancient — accounts of what is happening in the water.

The sacramental reading hears Romans 6:4 — 'we were buried with him through baptism into death' — and 1 Peter 3:21 — 'baptism that now saves you' — as Paul and Peter saying the rite itself is a real means of grace. The water does not save apart from Christ, but Christ uses the water as a covenantal sign that genuinely effects what it signifies. This is the historic Catholic, Orthodox, and Reformed pedobaptist reading: the church baptizes infants and adults alike, trusting that God works through the sign in advance of the recipient's full understanding, the way circumcision marked covenant membership before a Hebrew child could profess anything.

The ordinance reading hears Acts 2:38 — 'repent and be baptized' — and Acts 8:36-38, where the Ethiopian official is baptized only after he believes — as scripture insisting that baptism follows a personal, conscious turning to Christ. This is the Anabaptist and most Evangelical reading: the water is a public profession of a salvation already received by faith, an obedience commanded by Christ in Matthew 28:19, but not itself the cause or occasion of grace.

Both traditions read scripture carefully. Both honor the rite. Both confess Jesus as Lord. The visible sign is non-negotiable in either account. Where they diverge is the precise theology of how the water and the grace meet — and on that question, the church has not landed in one place, and this devotional will not pretend otherwise.

Historical context. The earliest extra-biblical Christian manual, the Didache (c. 50-120 AD), instructs believers to baptize 'in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, in living water' — preferring immersion in a flowing stream, but allowing pouring three times on the head when running water was unavailable. Mode flexibility shows up in the very first century. Theology of mode and meaning has continued to develop ever since.

BRIDGE

Ancient truth. Jesus walked down to the Jordan and was immersed by John before He commanded anyone else to be. The Voice spoke over the wet head of the Son: 'You are my Son, whom I love.' Sign and reality, water and Word, in the same breath.

Modern application. We live in a culture that distrusts visible signs. We want the inward thing without the outward one. But salvation is not bashful about bodies — it asks for water on skin, breath in lungs, food on the tongue. The interior rescue wears an exterior sign because we are not ghosts.

Connection. Even readers unsure of what the water does, do not doubt that Jesus walked into the Jordan first. The visible sign matters because Jesus made it matter — by submitting to it Himself before He asked it of anyone else.

New Testament echo. Matthew 28:19 — 'Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.' The Great Commission ties baptism into the very mission of the church. The risen Christ does not say 'preach my words and let people decide what to do with their bodies.' He says go, make disciples, baptize.

PRAYER

Jesus, You walked into the Jordan first. You did not ask of me what You did not do Yourself. The water on Your head was the Father's pleasure made visible, the Spirit's descent made gentle, the saved life made public. Whatever I have inherited or never received, whatever tradition I sit inside or wonder about from the edge — I want the visible sign of the invisible rescue. If I have been baptized, let me remember it today. If I have not, show me what holds me back, and walk me toward the water You walked into first. Amen.

Breathe in: 'I am washed.' Breathe out: 'I am claimed.'

REFLECTION

If you have been baptized, what do you remember about that day — and what does it mean to you now that you did not see when it happened? If you have not been baptized, what is the honest reason — and what would it cost to name it out loud?

- **Where in your life have you accepted an invisible reality without ever letting it wear a visible sign — and what has that cost the body of your faith?**
- **Which tradition shaped your understanding of baptism, and how might listening charitably to the other reading sharpen, rather than threaten, your own?**

TAKEAWAY

If I have not been baptized, I will name what holds me back — and bring it to a pastor, a friend, or a prayer this week. If I have been baptized, I will remember the day, thank God for the water, and walk today as someone whose rescue has already been made visible.

LEAVING AT THE CROSS

- The privatized faith that wants the inward rescue without the outward sign Christ Himself walked into
- The tribal certainty that uses my baptismal tradition to dismiss the faith of believers who read the same texts differently
- The shame or hesitation that has kept me from naming, out loud, what I do or do not yet understand about the water

RECEIVING FROM THE CROSS

- Jesus going down into the Jordan first — the saved life is one He has already walked into ahead of me
- βαπτίζω as plunging — a saturation, not a surface, that reorders what I belong to
- The Father's voice over the wet head of the Son: 'You are my Son, whom I love' — the same belovedness offered to me in Christ

RELATED SCRIPTURE

Mark 1:9-11. “At that time Jesus came from Nazareth in Galilee and was baptized by John in the Jordan. Just as Jesus was coming up out of the water, he saw heaven being torn open and the Spirit descending on him like a dove. And a voice came from heaven: 'You are my Son, whom I love; with you I am well pleased.'”

Matthew 28:19. “Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.”

Acts 8:36-38. “As they traveled along the road, they came to some water and the eunuch said, 'Look, here is water. What can stand in the way of my being baptized?'... Then both Philip and the eunuch went down into the water and Philip baptized him.”

1 Peter 3:21. “and this water symbolizes baptism that now saves you also — not the removal of dirt from the body but the pledge of a clear conscience toward God. It saves you by the resurrection of Jesus Christ.”

Baptism of the Spirit

Anchor: Acts 1:5

“For John baptized with water, but in a few days you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit.”

— Acts 1:5 (NIV)

ὁμεῖς δὲ ἐν πνεύματι βαπτισθήσεσθε ἁγίῳ

Read also: “When the day of Pentecost came, they were all together in one place. Suddenly a sound like the blowing of a violent wind came from heaven and filled the whole house where they were sitting. They saw what seemed to be tongues of fire that separated and came to rest on each of them. All of them were filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit enabled them.” — Acts 2:1-4

THE MOST ORDINARY MIRACLE

Water is something you walk into. Spirit is something you receive.

Notice the breath in your chest right now. The lift of the rib, the small return. You are not making it happen. Something is keeping you alive while you read this sentence, and you did not vote on it. The most ordinary thing in your body is a quiet miracle you can neither stage nor stop.

Yesterday we walked into water. Water is something we can prepare. We can fill the font, set the time, choose the words. The body goes under, the body comes up, and we do most of the verbs. The Spirit is different. Acts 1:5 has Jesus say it plainly: John baptized with water, but in a few days you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit. The grammar shifts. We were the subject of the first baptism. We are the object of the second.

Spirit is what we receive when we have nothing left to perform.

WORD STUDY

πνεῦμα

pneuma

Greek · Strong's G4151 · pronunciation: PNEW-mah

Definition. breath, wind, spirit

Root. From the verb πνέω (pneō), to breathe or to blow. The same noun names the air moving through your lungs, the wind moving through trees, and the Spirit moving through the upper room at Pentecost. Greek did not separate these meanings — context decides which English word a translator chooses.

Usage. The same word means breath, wind, and Spirit. Translators choose between the three based on context, but the original hearers heard one word doing three jobs at once. When the New Testament says the Spirit fills a room, the verb is the same one used for filling lungs.

רוח — **ruach** — Genesis 1:2 — 'the Spirit (ruach) of God was hovering over the waters.' Genesis 2:7 — 'the LORD God formed the man from the dust of the ground and breathed (a cognate verb) into his nostrils the breath (neshamah) of life.' Ruach is the Hebrew sister of pneuma: breath, wind, Spirit, all in one word. The God who breathed life into Adam at the first creation is the God who fills the disciples at the new one. Same act. Same word, in two languages.

πνοή — **pnoē** — Acts 2:2 — the 'rushing wind' at Pentecost. A cognate of pneuma. Luke is signaling: the breath that hovered over Genesis 1, the breath that filled Adam's lungs in Genesis 2, has now filled the room.

נְשָׁמָה — **neshamah** — Genesis 2:7 — the 'breath of life' God breathes into the human. Paired with ruach throughout the Hebrew Bible. The Spirit is not a foreign visitor; the Spirit is the Breath that has been making humans alive since the garden.

TWO FAITHFUL READINGS OF ONE PENTECOST

The church has read Acts 2 in more than one direction, and both readings have careful scriptural arguments.

The Reformed and cessationist tradition reads 1 Corinthians 12:13 as the floor: "For we were all baptized by one Spirit so as to form one body." Spirit baptism, on this reading, is what happens to every believer at the moment of regeneration — the Spirit indwells, seals, and incorporates the convert into the body of Christ in one act. Pentecost was a unique inaugural event, the public birth of the church. The gifts catalogued in 1 Corinthians 12 are real, but ordered toward the edification of the body rather than recurring spectacle, and certain sign gifts ceased once the apostolic foundation was laid. Benjamin Warfield made the classic case in *Counterfeit Miracles* (1918): the miraculous gifts authenticated the apostles, and with the apostolic age closed, their function closed with it.

The Pentecostal and continuationist tradition reads the same chapter and arrives elsewhere. Acts 2 is not only inaugural; Acts 8:14–17 (Samaritan believers receive the Spirit after conversion), Acts 19:1–7 (Ephesian disciples receive the Spirit subsequent to baptism), and Paul's own catalog in 1 Corinthians 12 describe a Spirit baptism distinct from regeneration — an empowering experience marked by tongues, prophecy, and the rest of the charismata, ongoing in the life of the church. The Azusa Street revival in Los Angeles (1906) launched the modern Pentecostal movement on this reading, and continuationists across denominations carry it now.

Both traditions stand on 1 Corinthians 12:13. One Spirit, one body, every believer. Whatever upper room you find yourself in, that floor holds.

Historical context. The Azusa Street Revival (Los Angeles, 1906), led by William J. Seymour, gave the modern Pentecostal movement its public ignition. Reformed cessationism in its modern shape was sharpened by Benjamin B. Warfield's *Counterfeit Miracles* (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1918), written as a polemical response to growing claims of charismatic gifts. Both arguments are scripturally serious, and both traffic in the same verses; faithful Christians within Nicene orthodoxy hold each.

BRIDGE

Ancient truth. At Pentecost the Spirit came as wind and fire — pneuma filling lungs that had been waiting in an upper room. The disciples did not summon the Spirit; they sat still until the Spirit arrived.

Modern application. We are fluent in performance. We can stage water, stage worship, stage the right posture and the right words. The Spirit is the only baptism we cannot fake. Fire does not arrive on cue, and wind does not blow because we asked nicely.

Connection. Spirit baptism is the part of the saved life we do not produce. We obey the water. We faith the steps. We sit, hands open, for the Breath. Receive, do not perform.

New Testament echo. 1 Corinthians 12:13 — "For we were all baptized by one Spirit so as to form one body — whether Jews or Gentiles, slave or free — and we were all given the one Spirit to drink."

PRAYER

Holy Spirit, I have tried to manufacture the things only You can give. I have rehearsed sincerity, performed surrender, and called the result Your presence. Today I want to stop. Breathe on me — the way You hovered over the deep, the way You filled Adam's lungs, the way You filled the upper room. I am not asking You to perform. I am asking to receive. Make me still long enough to be filled. Amen.

Breathe in: 'Holy Spirit, fill me.' Breathe out: 'I receive.'

REFLECTION

Where in your life have you been performing what you were meant to receive — staging the inner life instead of letting the Breath arrive?

- **If pneuma and ruach are the same Breath that filled Adam in Genesis 2 and the upper room in Acts 2, where do you most need that Breath today?**
- **What would it look like to be still long enough to be filled — not for an hour, but for the next ten minutes?**

TAKEAWAY

Today I will be still long enough to be filled.

LEAVING AT THE CROSS

- The exhausting habit of performing the Spirit's work in my own strength
- The quiet pride that prefers manufactured warmth to the discomfort of waiting
- The need to take a side in the cessationist–continuationist argument before I have first received the Spirit who unites both

RECEIVING FROM THE CROSS

- Pneuma and ruach as one Breath — the same Spirit who hovered over creation now hovering over me
- The honest relief that some baptisms cannot be staged; they can only be received
- 1 Corinthians 12:13 as common ground: one Spirit, one body, and I am inside it

RELATED SCRIPTURE

Acts 2:1-4. “When the day of Pentecost came, they were all together in one place. Suddenly a sound like the blowing of a violent wind came from heaven and filled the whole house where they were sitting. They saw what seemed to be tongues of fire that separated and came to rest on each of them. All of them were filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit enabled them.”

1 Corinthians 12:13. “For we were all baptized by one Spirit so as to form one body — whether Jews or Gentiles, slave or free — and we were all given the one Spirit to drink.”

Genesis 2:7. “Then the LORD God formed a man from the dust of the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and the man became a living being.”

John 3:8. “The wind blows wherever it pleases. You hear its sound, but you cannot tell where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit.”

Buried, Raised, Walking New

Anchor: Romans 6:4

“Or don't you know that all of us who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death? We were therefore buried with him through baptism into death in order that, just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, we too may live a new life.”

— Romans 6:3-4 (NIV)

ἢ ἀγνοεῖτε ὅτι ὅσοι ἐβαπτίσθημεν εἰς Χριστὸν Ἰησοῦν εἰς τὸν θάνατον αὐτοῦ
ἐβαπτίσθημεν; συνετάφημεν οὖν αὐτῷ διὰ τοῦ βαπτίσματος εἰς τὸν θάνατον, ἵνα
ὥσπερ ἠγέρθη Χριστὸς ἐκ νεκρῶν διὰ τῆς δόξης τοῦ πατρὸς, οὕτως καὶ ἡμεῖς ἐν
καινότητι ζωῆς περιπατήσωμεν

THE BAPTISM UNDERNEATH THE BAPTISM

The deepest baptism is not what you did at the font. It is what was done to you at the cross.

We have walked through six days of salvation. Rescue. The Voice that names the way. Past, present, future tenses of being saved. Faithing — trust as a verb. Water on skin. Spirit in the lungs.

Today we go to the floor.

Paul does not begin Romans 6 with technique. He begins with a question that assumes we have forgotten something foundational. "Don't you know that all of us who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death?" Not into a ceremony. Not into a community. Into His death. The water of Day 5 pointed here. The Spirit of Day 6 empowers from here. The grave is the floor of the saved life.

This is the convergence point. Reformed and Catholic, Orthodox and Wesleyan, Anabaptist and Pentecostal — every Christian tradition that has read Paul honestly arrives at the same place. Salvation is union with the crucified and risen Christ. Not similarity to Him. Not admiration of Him. Union.

WORD STUDY

συνθάπτω

synthaptō

Greek · Strong's G4916 · pronunciation: soon-THAP-toe

Definition. to bury together with, to be co-buried with

Root. A compound of syn- (with, together) and thaptō (to bury). The prefix is the load-bearing word. Paul does not say baptism resembles Christ's burial. He says we were buried with Him — interred in the same tomb, sharing the same grave.

Usage. συνετάφημεν (synetaphēmen) — "we were buried-together-with" — appears in Romans 6:4 and Colossians 2:12. It is one strand of a syn- family that fronts every key salvation verb in Paul's union-with-Christ theology. Sister word: συσταυρόω (systauroō, G4957) — "co-crucified" — Paul's confession in Galatians 2:20: "I have been crucified with Christ."

συσταυρόω (systauroō) — G4957 — co-crucified-with. Galatians 2:20: "I have been crucified with Christ and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me."

συνζωοποιέω (synezōpoiēsen) — Ephesians 2:5 — "made-alive-together-with" Christ when we were dead in transgressions.

συνεγείρω (synēgeren) — Ephesians 2:6, Colossians 3:1 — "raised-together-with" Christ. The grave is not the last verb.

CO-CRUCIFIED — THE GALATIANS 2:20 PATTERN

The cross is past tense for Christ. It is perfect tense for you — finished, but still standing.

Paul does not stop at the burial. He extends the syn- prefix backward to the cross itself. "I have been crucified with Christ" — Χριστῷ συνεσταύρωμαι — co-crucified. The verb is perfect tense in Greek: a past action with standing, present effect. Something happened to Paul on the day Christ died. He did not witness it. He participated in it, before he was born, before he believed, before he stopped persecuting the church.

John Calvin reads this passage and lands on what the tradition calls mortification — the daily putting to death of the old self that was already crucified with Christ. The cross is finished. The burial is finished. The mortification is the daily reckoning with what has already been done. We do not crucify ourselves into salvation. We learn, slowly and bodily, to walk as those who have already been buried.

BRIDGE

Ancient truth. Paul writes that we were buried with Christ — synetaphēmen — sharing the grave of the One who rose. Union, not imitation. Participation, not performance.

Modern application. We try to manage the old self as if it were still alive — negotiating with it, scolding it, promising it better behavior. Paul says we have already attended its funeral. The work now is to stop digging up what God has buried.

Connection. The saved life is a buried life walking. Faithing is the gait of someone who has already died. The water on Day 5 was the funeral. The Spirit on Day 6 is the breath of the resurrected. Today is the floor underneath both.

New Testament echo. Galatians 2:20 — "I have been crucified with Christ and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me. The life I now live in the body, I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me."

PRAYER

Jesus, I have been buried with You. I did not understand the cost when it was paid. I do not always feel the weight of the grave You shared with me. But the verb is perfect tense — finished and still standing. Teach me to walk as one who has already died. Teach me to stop reviving what You have buried. I receive the resurrection life that is already mine in You. Amen.

Breathe in: "I am buried with him." Breathe out: "I am raised with him."

REFLECTION

What in you needs to stay buried? Name one thing — a habit, a grievance, a self-image, a secret loyalty — that keeps climbing out of the grave Christ shared with you.

- **Where in your life are you still trying to manage the old self as if it were alive, instead of treating it as already crucified?**
- **If you woke tomorrow walking as someone who had already died with Christ, what would change in the first hour of your day?**

TAKEAWAY

I will name one thing in me that needs to stay buried — and I will stop digging it up.

LEAVING AT THE CROSS

- The exhausting effort to crucify a self Christ has already crucified
- The half-loyalty to the old life that keeps reviving what God has buried
- The lie that salvation is admiration of Christ from a safe distance, instead of union with Him at the grave

RECEIVING FROM THE CROSS

- Day 1 — Luke 19:10: "For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." The rescue is the beginning.
- Day 2 — John 14:6: "I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me." His own words.
- Day 3 — Ephesians 2:8-9: "For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith — and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God." Past, present, future — all gift.
- Day 4 — Habakkuk 2:4: "The righteous person will live by his faithfulness." Faithing — the verb that walks.
- Day 5 — Acts 2:38: "Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins." Water as sign.
- Day 6 — Acts 1:5: "For John baptized with water, but in a few days you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit." Spirit as breath.
- Day 7 — Romans 6:3-4: "All of us who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death... we too may live a new life." Union as floor.
- Carry these seven verses with you. They are the back-cover of the week — seven anchors for a saved-and-faithing life.

THE SEVEN ANCHORS

Carry these forward.

Day 1 · Saved From What?

Luke 19:10

Day 2 · His Own Words

John 14:6

Day 3 · Saved, Being Saved, Will Be Saved

Ephesians 2:8-9

Day 4 · Faithing

Habakkuk 2:4

Day 5 · Baptism of Water

Acts 2:38

Day 6 · Baptism of the Spirit

Acts 1:5

Day 7 · Buried, Raised, Walking New

Romans 6:4